

Engaging in educational activities during the reference period

This section presents information on the population aged 3 years and over who reported being engaged in “school education/13 years of guaranteed education” during the census reference period. Individuals who attended either a government or non-government school during the relevant reference period are considered to be participating in educational activities.

Table 7.5 : Population Engaged in School Education During the Reference Period by Age Group and Sex, 2024

Age group (Years)	Total population aged 5-24 years	Population engaged in school education	%	Male			Female		
				Total population	Population engaged in school education	%	Total population	Population engaged in school education	%
Total	6,695,363	4,351,225	65.0	3,367,403	2,157,831	64.1	3,327,960	2,193,394	65.9
05 - 10	1,893,872	1,578,999	83.4	959,815	799,153	83.3	934,057	779,846	83.5
11 - 14	1,397,847	1,329,915	95.1	709,634	672,962	94.8	688,213	656,953	95.5
15 - 16	720,137	658,982	91.5	365,655	331,356	90.6	354,482	327,626	92.4
17 - 18	726,524	488,622	67.3	367,328	225,986	61.5	359,196	262,636	73.1
19 - 24	1,956,983	294,707	15.1	964,971	128,374	13.3	992,012	166,333	16.8

Table 7.5 shows the total population, population engaged in school education during the reference period and the percentage by sex and age group. The percentage of females receiving school education is higher than that of males across all age groups.

The highest level of education attained by an individual

During the Census of Population and Housing, the highest educational qualification or the highest examination passed was obtained for every individual aged 5 years and over. Accordingly, this section presents the highest educational qualification attained by an individual through school or university education as of the census date. A large percentage of the population aged 25 and over were not engaged in educational activities during the reference period (Table 7.2). Therefore, we can assume most of the age 25 years and over have completed their education.

Level of education attained by the population aged 25 and over

As shown in Table 7.6, the highest percentage of the population aged 25 and over (58.4%) has attained a secondary level of education, a trend that remains consistent across both sexes. Furthermore, when considering tertiary education levels, the percentage of females is higher than that of males. When compared with data from the 2012 Census of Population and Housing, there is a significant decrease in the percentages of those who reported having no schooling or having only a primary education as their highest qualification in 2024. Among aged 25 and above 6,690,333(48.2%) persons have G.C.E(O/L) or more qualifications in 2024 this was 4,498,135 (37.3%) in 2012.

In 2024, the percentage of the population reporting tertiary education as their highest qualification (26.2%) has increased compared to the 2012 figure (18.2%), with a more pronounced increase observed among females than males. Compared to the 2012 Census, the proportion of the population reporting higher educational qualifications has increased in 2024, with relatively higher values reported for the female population.